

Design an experiment that can come back no.

What people actually do is the only thing that counts.

Validation that sets out to confirm will always find it.

A real test names what would prove you wrong, then goes looking for it.

He says yes, but he's dropped the same kind of app three times.

SAYS

"I'd practise every day."

The polite yes, easy to hear.

CHECK
BEHAVIOUR

Three apps,
abandoned in
a week.



DOES

Guitar in the case at 7pm.

Still shut at 9, the behaviour you can observe.

Predict his answer to a leading question.

"Would a practice app help you stick with guitar?" Anyone would say yes.

HOLD THE QUESTION

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The question shapes the answer he gives.

LEADING

"Would this help you practise?"

He says yes.

SAME TOMÁS

Only the
question
changed.



BEHAVIOUR

"What did you do at 7pm last night?"

Watched a video, same as every night.

THE POINT

The polite yes came from the leading question, not from Tomás.

Two rules every question must pass.

RULE ONE

Never mention your product.

If you frame the problem around your fix, you only hear about your fix.

RULE TWO

Ask what they actually did.

Past behaviour is recorded evidence, while future intent is guesswork.

Turn your riskiest assumption into a hypothesis you can disprove.

We believe ____ currently ____ because ____ wrong if ____ .

WE ARE WRONG IF

Name the behaviour you'd observe that disconfirms the belief, and write it before you ask anyone.

TOMÁS'S HYPOTHESIS

We believe the 7pm case keeps Tomás from playing because the easier thing wins, even though the guitar is tuned and in reach. We'd be wrong if teens named a different breaking point, unprompted.

Your turn.

FALSIFY Name what would prove you wrong. 10 min	DRAFT Write your own questions. 20 min	DEBIAS Fix the questions. 30 min	TIER Tier and set criteria. 10 min	DRY-RUN Rehearse before the field. 10 min
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First, name what would prove you wrong.

- 01 Start from the riskiest assumption you carried out of the market map.
- 02 Write one sentence: "We are wrong if ___, " observable and specific.
- 03 If you cannot say what would prove you wrong, no interview will either.

Write the questions only you can ask.

On your own, but try a few on the specialists beside you.

"Would you use {our fix} to solve {your problem}? Would you recommend it?"

WATCH FOR THIS SHAPE

Leading, future-tense, naming the product, and fishing for a yes.

Fix the questions in three moves.

These rules hold whether you wrote the question or a tool did.

- 01 Strip the product. Cut every word that names your fix.
- 02 Replace "would" with "did". Ask about what they already did.
- 03 Open a door to no. Each question must invite a disconfirming answer.

Before the first interview, decide where to dig and what counts.

TIER, THEN GO DEEP

Mark your must-asks.

Pick the few questions you cannot skip. On those, use the Five Whys from week one, asking why and then why again, until you reach the reason behind what they did.

WRITTEN CRITERIA

What counts as a yes or no.

A polite yes cannot be counted as a yes after the interview is over.

Rehearse before the field.

- 01 Run the protocol on a peer specialist, two minutes per question.
- 02 Peer flags every line that fishes for yes, and you rewrite on the spot.
- 03 Best debiased questions feed the shared Field Kit the group takes out this afternoon.

DRY-RUN PASSED

Can your experiment come back no?

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DISCONFIRMING SIGNAL

The behaviour that, if you see it,
you are wrong.

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DEBIASED QUESTIONS

Past tense, no product named,
open to a no.

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WRITTEN CRITERIA

Yes and no, written before the
first interview.

Take this back to your team and shape one plan together.

Real behaviour decides this.

OUT IN MARKET #1 • TUE PM

Run your protocol on real users.

Write down what each person actually did, not what they say they would do.

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FEEDS

Your product brief and your final pitch.

The validation you design here is the heart of what you present.

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